

Mitzenmacher (2003).

“To come very near true theory and to grasp its precise application are two very different things as the history of science teaches us. Everything of importance has been said before by somebody who did not discover it.” Whitehead (1925).

Fractals in poetry: For the quote on Dickinson, see Fulton (1998).

Lacunarity: Brockman (2005). In the arts, Mandelbrot (1982).

Fractals in medicine: “New Tool to Diagnose and Treat Breast Cancer,” *Newswise*, July 18, 2006.

General reference books in statistical physics: The most complete (in relation to fat tails) is Sornette (2004). See also Voit (2001) or the far deeper Bouchaud and Potters (2002) for financial prices and econophysics. For “complexity” theory, technical books: Bocarra (2004), Strogatz (1994), the popular Ruelle (1991), and also Prigogine (1996).

Fitting processes: For the philosophy of the problem, Taleb and Pilpel (2004). See also Pisarenko and Sornette (2004), Sornette et al. (2004), and Sornette and Ide (2001).

Poisson jump: Sometimes people propose a Gaussian distribution with a small probability of a “Poisson” jump. This may be fine, but how do you know how large the jump is going to be? Past data might not tell you how large the jump is.

Small sample effect: Weron (2001). Officer (1972) is quite ignorant of the point.

Recursivity of statistics: Taleb and Pilpel (2004), Blyth et al. (2005).

Biology: Modern molecular biology pioneers Salvador Luria and Max Delbrück witnessed a clustering phenomenon with the occasional occurrence of extremely large mutants in a bacterial colony, larger than all other bacteria.

Thermodynamics: Entropy maximization without the constraints of a second moment The two exhaustive domains of attraction: vertical or straight line with slopes either negative infinity or constant negative α . Note that since probabilities need to add up to 1 (even in France) there cannot be other alternatives to the two basins, which is why I narrow it down to these two exclusively.